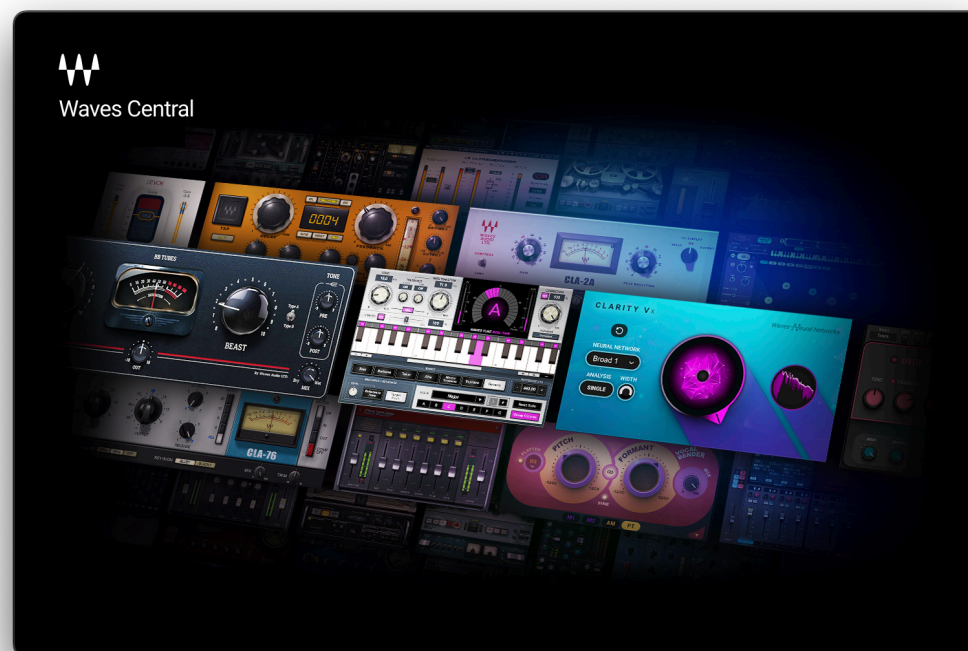




Waves Central

User Guide



Use Waves Central to install and activate the latest version of Waves products.

Navigating Waves Central

Learn More

Waves Central is organized in eight pages that can be accessed via the tabs on the left side. Want to learn more about a topic? Click the nearby 'Learn More' button. This will take you to a detailed, up-to-date article that tells you what you need to know.

Main Section

The screenshot shows the Waves Creative Access dashboard. On the left, a vertical sidebar contains eight tabs: Creative Access, Install Products, Licenses, Offline Installer, iLUGEN, StudioVerse, What's New?, and Settings/Support. Each tab is accompanied by a descriptive text label and a blue arrow pointing to it. The main content area is titled 'Welcome to Waves Creative Access' and includes a 'Get Full Access' button. To the right of the main content is a promotional banner for '25% Off Bundles & Upgrades' with a 'Shop Now' button. A blue line with dots at the ends spans the width of the dashboard, with a label 'Main Section' at the top and 'Summary of pending install/activate activity' on the right. At the bottom of the dashboard, there is a search bar and a user profile section.

Manage plugin subscriptions

Install and activate Waves products

Manage and move licenses

Create and run offline installers

Explore text-to-sound sample generation

Get started with StudioVerse

Releases, product info, and purchasing options

File locations, privacy, and maintenance

Support articles, specs, and system information

Waves Creative Access

Welcome to Waves Creative Access

Subscribe to all Waves plugins, plus the StudioVerse plugins.

Get Full Access

Ensure that your system and DAW support Waves plugins.

My Subscriptions

You have no subscriptions yet: [Subscribe now.](#)

Looking for your perpetual licenses? Go to [My Products.](#)

Limited Time

25% Off Bundles & Upgrades

Use Code: **SAVE25**

Shop Now

Summary of pending install/activate activity

Find: [All Products](#) | [Live Sound Apps](#) | [Legacy Versions](#) | [Sample Libraries](#)

There are four useful tools at the top of the window:

Search

Tour walks you through the most common processes in Waves Central.

Search helps you locate products directly.

Reload refreshes Central.

Notifications displays important alerts and updates.

Username identifies the current Waves account. Click on the down arrow to review your account or log out.

Creative Access Page: Set Up a Subscription

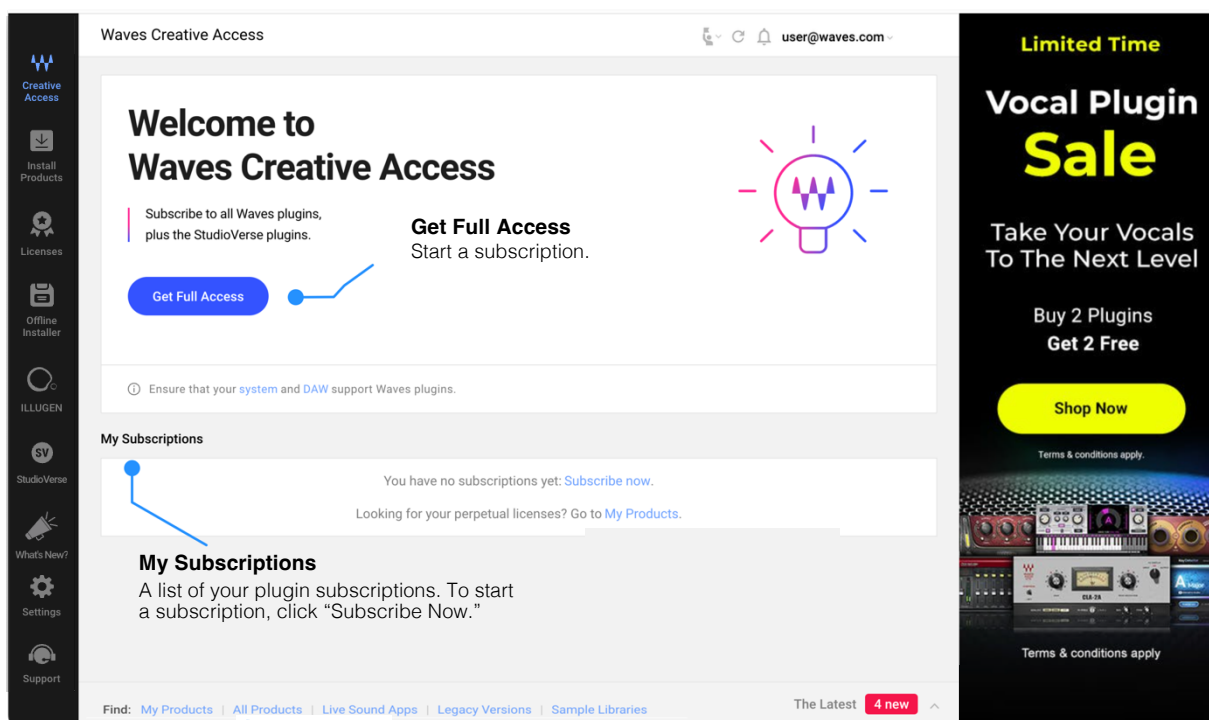
The Creative Access page is the gateway to Waves Creative Access subscriptions. From here you can start, install, activate, and manage subscriptions, as well as get updates.

Getting Started

To get started, you'll need a Waves account. If you've ever purchased a Waves product, you have an account. If not, you can set one up from the waves.com home page.

My Subscriptions shows your Creative Access subscriptions. If you don't already have one, click [Get Full Access](#). This link will take you to the Waves Creative Access page, where you can start your subscription.

When you install and activate your subscription, you will be asked where you want to activate your license: on this computer or on a USB flash drive. You will also be asked if you want to download the Waves sample libraries. These libraries, which are used by the Waves sampler and virtual instruments, are very large. If you do not use these products, you may choose not to download the sample files now. You can always download them later.



My Products

A list of all Waves products for which you have a license.

All Products

Access to the latest products, as well as Waves legacy products.

Live Sound

A list of all available Waves Live sound applications and drivers.

Legacy Versions

Links to the offline Installers page for older versions of Waves products.

Sample Libraries

Takes you to a web page where you can download sample libraries for Waves virtual instruments.

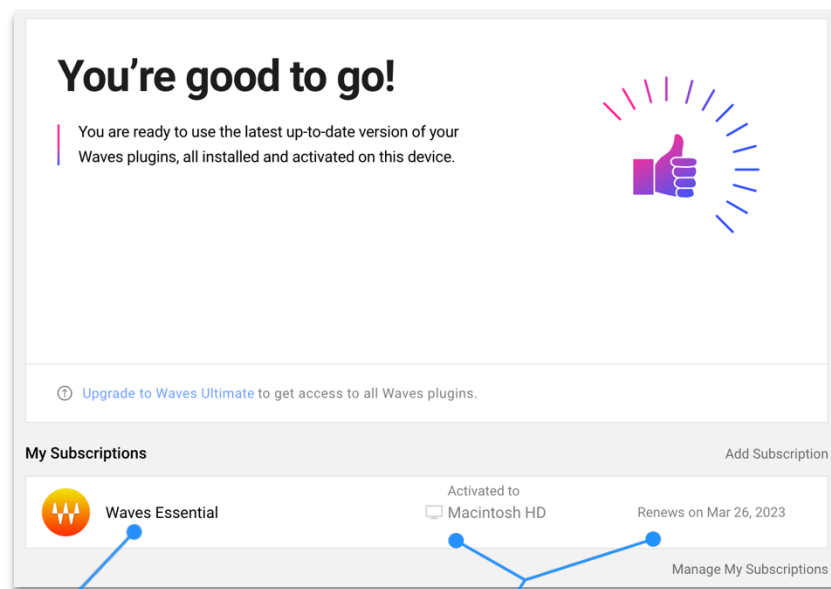
Creative Access Ultimate installs the entire catalog of Waves plugins, while the Essential subscription installs only plugins within its scope. If you are using Essential, you can always demo Ultimate plugins. The plugin will be fully functional, but there will be occasional mutes.

Install and Activate Your Subscription Later

If you're not ready to install and activate your Waves Creative Access subscription at the time of purchase, don't click [Install & Activate](#) on the waves.com purchase page. You can install this later with Waves Central.

Install & Activate

You can also install and activate from the Waves Central Creative Access page by clicking [Install & Activate](#). If you have already installed the plugins, you will see only [Activate](#) on the button.



Once your subscription is ready to go, you'll see this page.

Learn More

Subscription Options

If you have more than one subscription, they will all appear here.

Subscription Status

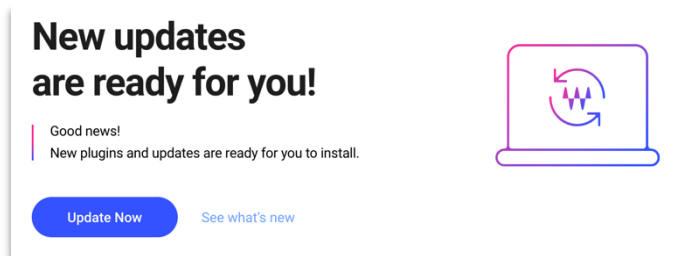
Shows the status and location of the license and the date of the next automatic payment.

Manage Your Subscription

Takes you to the **My Subscription** page in your Waves account.

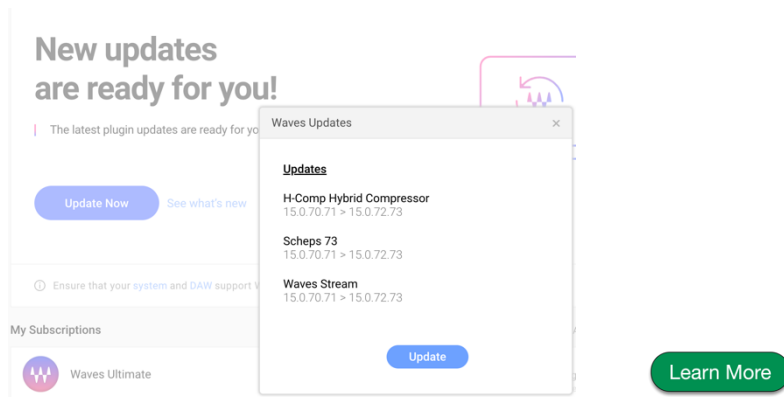
Creative Access Updates

When new plugins are available for your Waves Creative Access subscription, a blue Update button will appear on the Waves Creative Access page.



Click the Update button to see a list of updates that will be installed. If a new plugin is available, it will appear at the top of the list. Click the [Update](#) button in this window to update/install plugins.

We recommend that you regularly visit Waves Central to check for updates.



Install and Activate Products

The Install and Activate Products page shows all Waves products. Here you can install and activate your products, update products, and find legacy product installers. If you have subscribed to Waves Creative Access—and have no other Waves products—you will probably not need to visit this page, since you can manage your subscription in the Creative Access page.

My Products
A list of your Waves products

Plugin Subscriptions
View subscriptions

All Products
A list of all Waves products

View
Use the View menu to filter products by version type / use.

Product	Update plan	License location	Activated	Installed
Abbey Road J37 Tape V12.0.0 Visit store page		Not Activated	—	—
API Collection V16.0.0 Visit store page		Not Activated	—	✓
F6 Floating-Band Dynamic EQ V14.0.0 Visit store page		sted	—	—
Mercury V15.0.4 Visit store page		Untitled	✓	V16
Waves Essential V16.0.0 Visit store page		Untitled	✓	✓
Z-Noise V9.2.0		Not Activated	—	Learn more
Waves Online Mastering Visit page	Standard	0 credits left: Buy more		

Find: [Legacy Versions](#) | [Sample Libraries](#)

Waves Essential
SD HD

A small notepad icon indicates that there is more than one plugin associated with this download. Click to see download contents.

Updates available

This notification appears when product updates are available. These may include product improvements or bug fixes. By default, all relevant plugins are updated to the latest version but, to save time, you can deselect plugins that you don't want to update presently. A restart may be required after an update.

My Products

- Use the [View](#) menu to filter products by version, type, and use.
- You can install the current product version online. Click the button next to the product name to add product to the install queue. Your selections will appear in the [Selected Products](#) list on the right. Click the X to remove products from the queue.
- If you are installing sample libraries, you can select between the SD and HD versions, or none.
- Click [Install](#) to install the selected products. If there are licenses to be activated, choose the device where you want to send them (your computer or a USB flash drive). Click [Install and Activate](#).
- If your list includes products of an unsupported version, you will see a [Learn More](#) on the right side. This takes you to a link where you can read about your download options.

Plugin Subscriptions

- Shows the Waves subscriptions available for installation and activation.

All Products

- View and install the current version of all Waves products, whether you have a license or not.
- SoundGrid applications are not licensed under a subscription; activate their licenses separately.

[Learn More](#)

Manage Licenses

Use the Licenses page to activate, move, deactivate, or recover a license.

Licenses

NOT ACTIVATED CONNECTED DEVICES

Search user@waves.com

View All

Export licenses status to a CSV file.

Licenses selected for activation.

Central can remind you that it's nearing time to renew a license. Remind Me sets a reminder in your personal calendar. Open the drop-down menu to choose your calendar.

Selected Products

The following licenses will be activated on device Macintosh HD.

Summary

BB Tubes V15.0.0 | Full License 65ADAA09D6E74A9195BF861487E373...

Diamond V15.0.0 | Full License C39064A385D54B6CAE34D8F416C507...

Target for Licenses: Macintosh HD

Selected Products

Review selected licenses. Choose destinations for license and sample libraries.

Activate

Waves Online Mastering Get Started »

Not Activated

This is a list of your licenses that are not activated to a device.

To activate a license:

- Select your product licenses (they will appear in the summary on the right).
- Click [Activate](#).

The selected license is activated to your computer or a USB flash drive. When a license has been activated on a device, it will no longer appear in this list.

[Learn More](#)

Connected Devices

This shows the licenses activated on this computer or on a USB flash drive connected to it.

To deactivate a license:

- Select your products.
- Click [Deactivate](#) (the license moves to your Not Activated list).

[Learn More](#)

Disconnected Devices

This is a list of your licenses on devices that are not connected to this computer. It can be used to recover a license from a device that has been damaged or lost.

To recover a license:

- Select the products.
- Click [Recover](#) (default).

The selected license is sent back to your Not Activated list or to a connected device. You can recover a license once per year.

[Learn More](#)

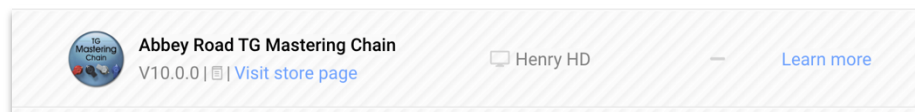
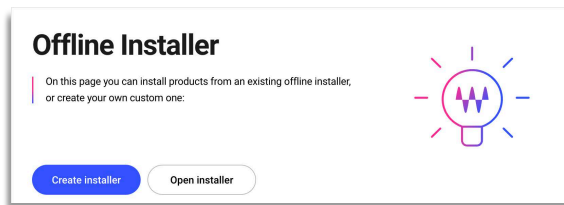
Offline Installer

Waves products V11 or later can be installed online with Waves Central. There are, however, occasions when you cannot or don't want to install online, such as:

- When installing Waves products to a computer that is not connected to the internet.
- When there are issues with the internet connection that prevent the products from being downloaded properly.

In these cases, you can create an offline installer, a one-click customizable tool for product installation.

To install from an offline installer, follow these steps:



- Click [Open Installer](#).
- Navigate to the offline installer and select it. You can open the installer folder and click on the "install.cen" file or drag the installer directly onto the Waves Central interface.
- Click [Install](#).

[Learn More](#)

If your list of products in the My Products tab of the Install Products page includes products of a previous version, you will see [Learn More](#) on the right side. This takes you to a link where you can download the offline installer for that version.

[Learn More](#)

To create an offline installer of current Waves software, follow these steps:

- Click [Create Installer](#). Select the products for your offline installer.
- In the Selected Products panel, choose a platform according to the target offline computer (Mac or Windows).
- Click [Create an Installer](#).

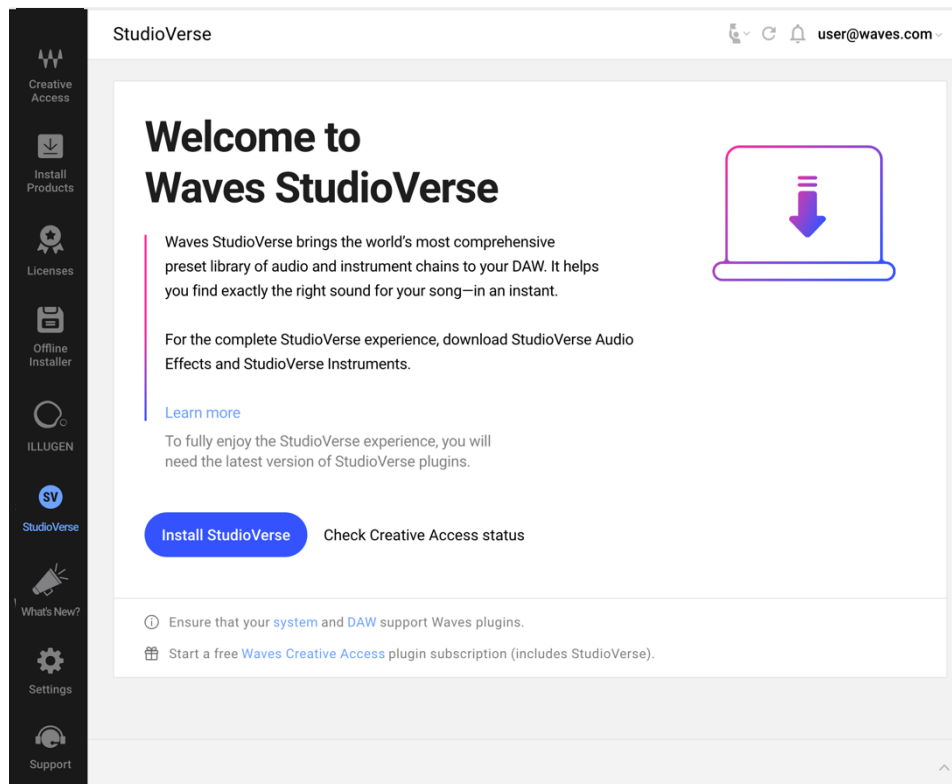
Note: An offline installer does not include your license. Use the Licenses page to transfer licenses. If you want to move between host computers, you may choose to activate your license to a USB flash drive rather than your host computer's drive. A legacy product will work with a newer license, so you can combine a subscription with your legacy plugins.

StudioVerse

This is your introduction to StudioVerse. From this page, you can visit the StudioVerse web site to learn what StudioVerse has to offer or install the entire the Waves plugins library so that you can demo all the StudioVerse plugin chains.

A plugin chain is a record of the structure, plugins, and settings of an instance of StudioVerse. It is a comprehensive snapshot of the chain. StudioVerse lets you store and recall your chains online so you can access them from any location, but that's just the beginning: StudioVerse is an online community where you can post your chains and share them with other users or load chains from industry-leading pros. StudioVerse can even scan a track and recommend chains based on the sonic fingerprint of your track.

A StudioVerse chain includes macros that help you adjust the chain's controls, based on sound attributes, not numbers.



StudioVerse Status

This page manages your StudioVerse environment. It considers which plugins are installed on your computer and advises the best course of action to get the most from StudioVerse.

Controls on this page change according to your configuration and needs.

Click [Install StudioVerse](#) to update to the latest version or install all Waves plugins so that you can preview all the chains that StudioVerse has to offer.

Unlicensed plugins will load fully functioning into chains, but there will be periodic audio drops until the plugin is licensed or removed from the chain.

Check Creative Access Status

Takes you to the Creative Access section, where you can check the status of your subscription account.

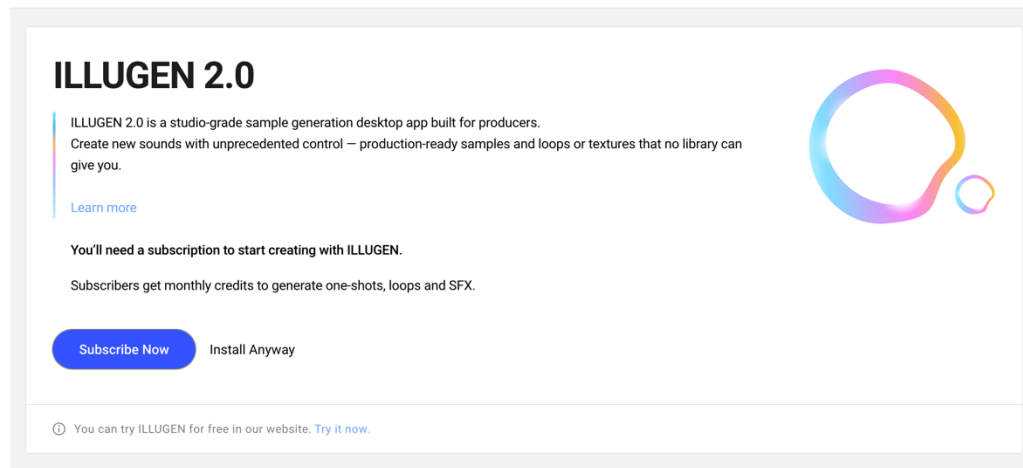
[Learn More](#)

ILLUGEN

With ILLUGEN, you can transform your creativity into one-of-a-kind, never-before-heard one-shot sounds, loops and FX directly from text prompts. Instead of browsing a traditional sample library, ILLUGEN offers a new, freer approach to sound design.

Every sound generated with ILLUGEN is original, and entirely yours.

This page contains all you need to get started with ILLUGEN: You can purchase an active subscription, install ILLUGEN or purchase more credits.

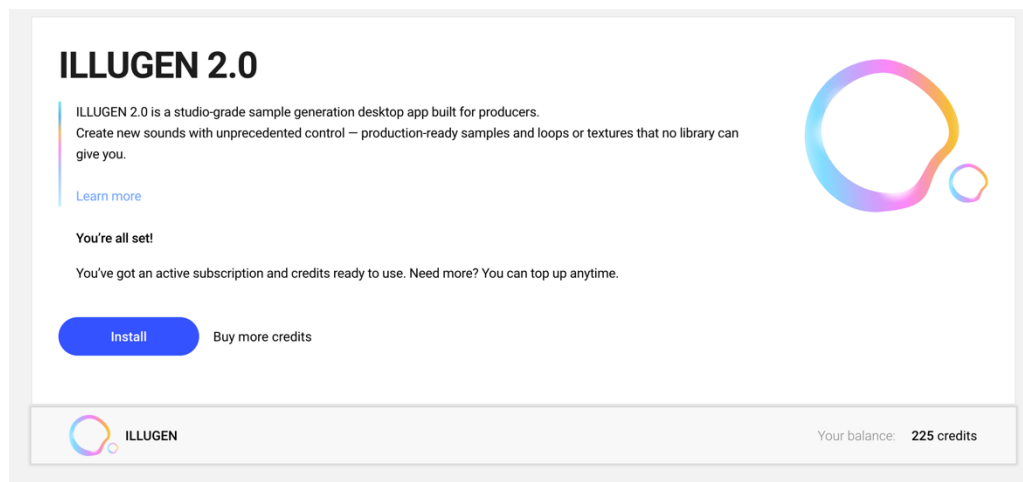


Install

Click this option to have the latest version of ILLUGEN set up on your machine.

Subscribe Now / Buy More Credits

Takes you to ILLUGEN Subscription page on Waves.com, where you can choose from three monthly packages and start generating sounds immediately.

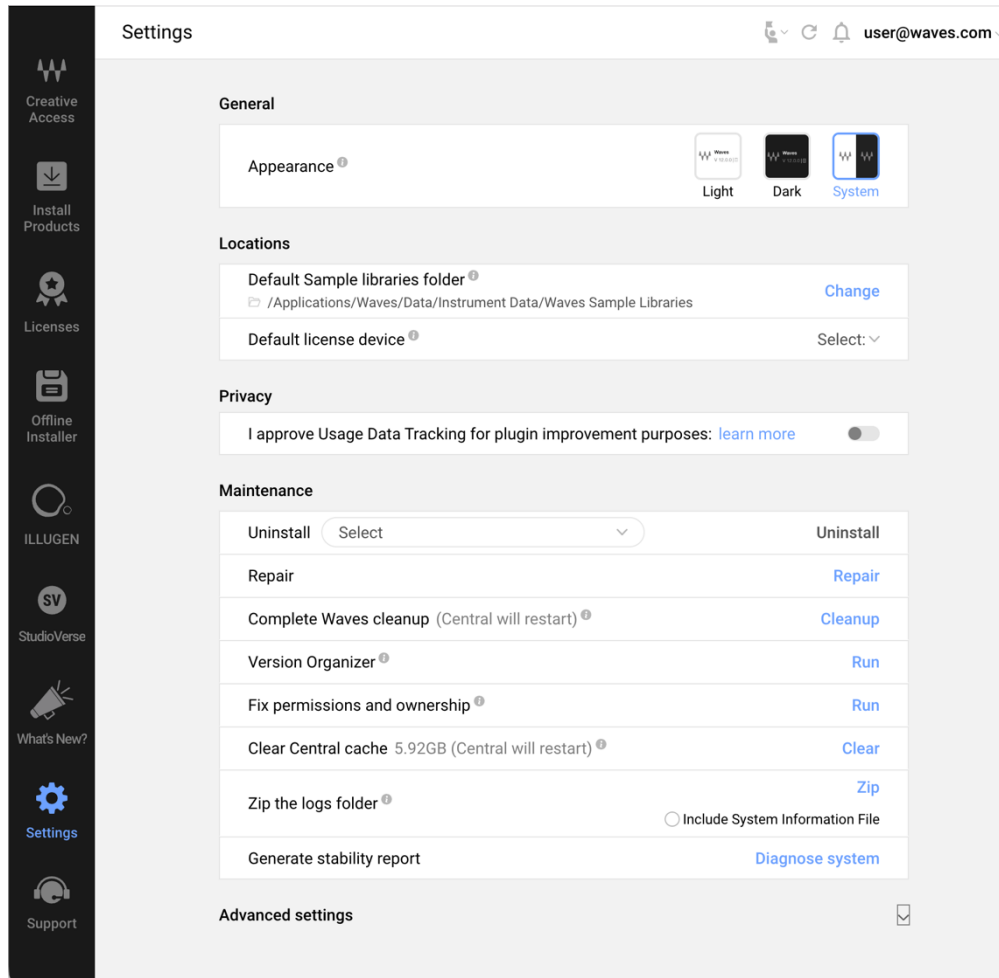


Your Balance

Shows how many credits you already have in your account.

Settings

The Settings page is used to control the look of the interface and the default file locations, as well as to clean up your plugin files. Each control has a [tooltip](#) or a prompt that explains its function.



General

Set the look of the interface.

Locations

Set the default location of your Waves sample libraries and licenses.

Privacy

Allow Waves Audio to collect plugin usage data for product improvement.

Maintenance

Tools for troubleshooting and cleaning up your system. Supplies system information to Waves technical support, if necessary.

Advanced Settings

Click this option to enable Waves Central's Remote Assistance mode.

The first time you launch Waves Central, or if Central detects a permissions problem, it will automatically repair Waves file and folders permissions and ownership to ensure a clean installation. If you later encounter installation problems, you can run “Fix permissions and Ownership” manually.

Support

The Support page answers questions about installing, managing, and updating your Waves products. You will also find technical requirements, system information, release notes, and contact information on this page.

Creative Access

Install Products

Licenses

Offline Installer

ILLUGEN

StudioVerse

What's New?

Settings

Support

Support

Support

Waves Central manual

Help

[Find instant answers](#)

[Waves Creative Access - Frequently asked questions](#)

[Waves Update Plan](#)

[Frequently asked questions](#)

[Register a product serial](#)

[Login issues](#)

[Waves Central errors and troubleshooting](#)

[Computer appears as disconnected device in Waves Central](#)

[How to solve 'Installation Failed' errors in Waves Central](#)

[How to move licenses](#)

[How to rescan plugins in your DAW](#)

[Download a legacy Offline Installer](#)

[Download Sample Libraries](#)

[Download Team Viewer for remote assistance](#)

Tech Specs

Legal

System Information

Need more help? Get in touch: [Email Tech Support](#) | [1-865-909-9200 ext.1](#) (Long distance charges may apply)

Waves technical support contact information is shown at the bottom of the page.